Vamsi Kanakam, PMP®

Project Manager | Capacity & Resource Planning | Operations | Scheduling & Workload Management | PMO & Governance

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

PMP-certified Project Manager with **~10** years of experience across **Capacity planning, Resource management, Manufacturing operations, Digital transformation** and **PMO**. Experienced in translating business demand into capacity and resource plans, managing schedules and workloads, tracking operational KPIs, and driving corrective actions across complex cross-functional environments. Led strategic and operational initiatives across **India, Japan** and the **U.S**., partnering with senior leadership to improve capacity, execution visibility and operational performance.

KEY SKILLS

• Project Governance & PMO	• Stakeholder and People Leadership
• Process Design & Operating model Implementation	• Capacity and Resource Planning
• Critical Path Monitoring & Execution	• Vendor sourcing & Management
• Executive Reporting	• Capital Budgeting & Baseline Monitoring
• Issue & Risk Management	• Prototyping & Iterative Development
• Value Stream Mapping	• PDCA
• Operations Performance	• CAPA
• Lean Management	• Digital Transformation through Industry 4.0

EDUCATION

National Institute of Technology, Rourkela | B Tech | Mechanical Engg, CGPA - 8.3 (Top 9%) (May'2012 – May'2016)

Sri Chaitanya Junior college, Visakhapatnam | Intermediate (MPC) - 90.10% (Top 10%) (Mar'2009 - April'2011)

Public School, Jeypore | ICSE – 86.4% (Top 5%) (Mar'2007 - Mar'2009)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Hummingbird Scientific, Hyderabad | Project Manager- PMO – Planning, M&C, Leadership & Development (*Feb'25 – Present)*

- Manage a team of 6 Engineers, 3 Sales/Applications, 2 Scientists, 6 Machinists prioritizing resources across concurrent programs, balancing workload against capacity constraints, and aligning team execution with business priorities and delivery commitments and action as a liaison between the team and the Senior Management.
- Led the flagship **Optical Bulk Electrochemistry Liquid TEM** Holder program from executive charter to commercial release; translating the **VOC** into **Program drivers,** enforced **RICE prioritization,** established **Stage-Gate governance** & **target-date back-scheduling** to ensure Time to Market launch **12 days early**, achieving **Revenue 120%** of **target**.
- Managed end-to-end engineering readiness of the **MEMS Heating + Biasing Holder**, coordinating interdependent thermal, electrical, mechanical, tilt & spectroscopy requirements through structured milestone planning, design-trade-off reviews, dependency management & validation tracking; reduced **engineering change iterations by 29%**, improved **requirements traceability** from **76%** to **98%**, & delivered the program with **<5% schedule variance**.
- Coordinated **12 cross-functional stakeholders** by redesigning execution tracking around standardized status reporting, decision logs and action ownership, reducing status follow-ups by **75%** and improving visibility into blockers and commitments.
- Owned executive reporting on program health, Capacity, Resource constraints, Risks and Execution priorities, consolidating PMIS data into **Program health reports** & **Time-0 action trackers** for leadership-ready updates to report to the Senior Management including the CEO.
- Built and implemented **12 standardized PM operating procedures** across Engineering, Sales and Leadership within **2 months**, establishing repeatable planning, tracking and escalation mechanisms with **100%** process adherence.
- Established a cross-functional **Roles and Responsibilities** framework to clarify ownership, resolve execution gaps and improve project turnaround time by **20%**, achieving **100%** ownership clarity.
- Partnered with executive leadership to redesign operational planning around capacity forecasting and resource requirements, developing a 5-year planning framework that supported **1.5×** production capacity and **30%** throughput improvement.
- Owned **Rolling 12-month capacity** and **Production planning** by translating the **5-year Sales Plan** into resource and scheduling priorities; reduced schedule conflicts with Engineering projects by up to **20%** through quarterly baseline updates and ongoing execution tracking.

ITC Limited, HO Bangalore | Manager – NPD, Industry 4.0 & Digital transformation Projects **(*Nov'23 – Oct'24)***

- Managed **30+ order approvals with Production, Vendors, Finance** within **2 months** using SLA's, war rooms, & resource planning to meet deadlines by managing **15 stakeholders** simultaneously for Streamlined & Parallel execution.
- Managed the Operational transition from **SCADA** to **AI-driven Digital Twin transformation** by leading a cross-functional **ScrumBan**

team through planning, execution, & deployment, enabling real-time process optimization & predictive operational insights that improved finished goods consistency & product quality to **95%+** while reducing fuel consumption by **5%**.

- Improved **Embedding visibility** by **29%** & established 100% QC system, resulting in Savings of **indirect loss** by **6.2C r** through Process control & execution visibility.
- Implemented **AI-enabled Vision systems**, reducing customer complaints from **67%** to **0%** by transitioning QC process from Manual inspection to Digital across all applicable locations in ITC (CMU's & ICML's) for identifying creme defects, & deployed **RFID** for **Real-time Trolley monitoring** for Foolproof & efficient QC in fermentation rooms.
- Standardized **Quality-control, Process-flow, RCA** and **Installation workflows** through **7 templates** benchmarked over **8 months**.
- Led procurement process transformation by customizing the **1VP platform** to standardize RFQ, Estimation, Supplier evaluation, Negotiation & Ordering workflows, establishing Procurement governance & approval SLAs that reduced procurement cycle time by 85% while improving cross-functional process visibility.
- Ensured **100%** closure of critical path activities & project performance tracking through **EVM** & **Baseline** monitoring.

Maruti Suzuki India Ltd, HO Gurgaon | Deputy Manager – NPD (Body Engineering Division) ***(Jul'16 – Nov'23)***

- Successfully led **12 Greenfield** and **Brownfield** programs across the NPD lifecycle, integrating production capacity, resource requirements, schedules, suppliers and investment priorities across a **₹1000 Cr+** annual capital portfolio.
- Spearheaded capacity-up planning for a high-volume production line by analyzing demand, capacity constraints and resource requirements; developed the business case and coordinated execution with Cross functional teams across Engineering, R&D, QA, Prod, Maintenance & Plant Control, to increase annual output by **21%** from **207K** to **250K** vehicles annually while reducing cycle time by **18%**.
- Handled a team of **15** members for end to end project delivery including Project Charters, SOW, WBS, Process Flow Diagrams, Project Scheduling & Management, and coordinated with **10+ members** in **Production** regarding New model development.
- Increased new model line efficiency from **85%** to **99%** by identifying Bottle neck stations, tracking & elimination of faults in the highest volume line of Maruti Suzuki by introducing WICS (First in MSIL).
- Product owner for managing **ECN's (Change Management)** for 8 Project Managers, Supervisor's through Scrum for **8 Running Models** for a period of **2 Years** with successful implementation of **570+** ECN's & auditing to ensure **100%** adherence to standarrds & timely implementation on the production line.
- Spearheaded various impactful **industry 4.0** projects organization wide with end-to-end transition from Manual stations to OT Connectivity Industry 4.0 Monitoring systems for specific use cases under QC, Process improvement & Cost saving like:
    - Developing Business case & implementing solution of **WICS** which is a MES, by quantifying operational bottlenecks, projected productivity gains, & financial impact, securing executive approval. Led end-to-end implementation & post-deployment benefits tracking, reducing weld-quality downtime from **14%** to **3%** by proactively preventing issues from happening, retaining data of every body for 10 years, for easy back tracking & reference & unlocking production capacity equivalent to **101 additional weld bodies** per day with a payback period of **~2.5 months**.
    - Integrated **laser sensors** for **Sealer Real Time Monitoring** – CT **reduction** of **5 sec** per vehicle, leading to Organization wide Digital transformation across all factories.
    - Interconnected AGV for Efficient material trolley transfer to loading areas – Wait time reduction of 2400 sec/day.
- Managed new model projects from the **Volume** & **Feasibility** study, **Cycle time** analysis, **Design Proto-trial stages** to **SOP** which include Detailed **Spec prep**, **RFQ/Tender** preparation, **Technical & Commercial Negotiation**, **Supplier end Buyoff**, **Installation, trials** & **Commissioning** through cross functional team collaboration.
- Incharge of the Capital Budgeting for the BIW Dept for a period of 2 years, with experience managing **CAPEX portfolios** exceeding **₹2,000+ Crores annually** within high-volume automotive manufacturing.
- Coordinated **end-to-end onboarding** of multiple suppliers like Nexgen, Wemech etc by managing vendor documentation, cross-functional qualification workflows & approval tracking across Procurement, Finance & technical teams, enabling timely supplier qualification.
- Project **Contingency planning & Baseline monitoring** to keep a check on Scope creep, Cost overruns & gold plating.
- Interaction with **Cross functional** teams including R&D, NPE, PC, PPC, QA, SC& Prod ensuring Model development schedule is on track.
- Managed & Supervised timely **Stage Gate approvals** for closure related to **Design proto-trial**, **Pre-production proto-trial**, **Mass-Production**, **Pilot** & **SOP**, ensuring closure of all **Quality**, **Safety**, **Process, Productivity** & **Maintenance** related snags.
- Conducting Weekly **Retrospective** team meetings for **New Technology Trials** & Monthly **Townhall meetings** with Top management.
- Experience in **establishing PMO's** by framing the policies, process flow & governance structure, ensuring proper information & Knowledge management through Lessons learned & other updating OPA's.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Project & Delivery:** Capacity & Resource Planning, Workload & Scheduling Management, LiquidPlanner, MS Project, Excel, Power BI
- **AI & Automation**: Prompt Engineering, AI-assisted workflows, Documentation & analysis (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot), Vibe Coding (Base44, Figma Make)
- **Product & Design:** User flows, Prototyping (Figma, Miro)
- **Reporting & Analytics** – Power BI, Powerpoint, Microsoft Excel

CERTIFICATIONS

- **PMP Certified (By PMI)** – **(PMP No-3389780)** - Secured Highest order in People, Process & Environment Domains
- **Product Management Professional** certified by **Institute of Product Leadership** – 2024-25 Batch
- **Lean Six Sigma Green Belt** Certified by **Six Sigma Academy Amsterdam**